

2 — Colours and Building Blocks

(Plain-English version of `docs/10-design-system.md`. Read that file for the full detail.)

This is the kit of parts everything is built from. The goal: build it once in Figma, and both design and code use the exact same values. Nothing should use a random colour or size that isn't in this kit.

Design tokens (name your styles)

A “token” is just a named style — like “main button colour” instead of a raw hex code. Set them up in three layers:

1. **Raw values** — the basic values (a green, a spacing size). Not used directly on screens.
2. **Named-by-job values** — like “main action colour” or “raised surface”. This is the layer that changes between light, dark, and sepia mode.
3. **Part-specific values** — only when one part needs its own, like “primary button background”.

Use clear names like `colour.action.primary`. The name in Figma must match the name in code exactly.

Spacing (built on 4px)

Everything is a multiple of 4px:

`4 · 8 · 12 · 16 · 20 · 24 · 32 · 40 · 48 · 64`

Simple rules: 16px padding inside cards, 24px between cards, and leave room at the bottom of screens so the bottom nav bar doesn't cover content.

Text sizes

Name	Size	Used for
Display	32px	Big moments (a milestone, a certificate)
Title large	24px	Screen titles
Title medium	20px	Card titles, section headings
Title small	17px	List item titles
Body large	18px	Bible and devotional reading (can be resized 14–28px)
Body medium	16px	Normal text
Body small	14px	Secondary info, dates
Caption	12px	Small labels, timestamps, verse numbers

Colours (named by job)

Name	Job
Surface (base / raised / sunken)	Backgrounds — soft off-white (light), soft dark (dark), warm paper (sepia)
Text (primary / secondary / muted)	Text, always easy to read on its background
Action primary	The green — buttons and the active tab
Accent celebrate	The amber — only for celebration moments
Feedback (success / info / caution / error)	System messages only. Error is never used on games/streaks
Highlight 1–4	Bible highlight colours (later version)
Border (subtle / strong)	Lines, dividers, input outlines

For the leader Console there are also status colours: draft (grey), review (blue), scheduled (purple), published (green), archived (muted). And for event sign-ups: pending (amber), confirmed (green), waitlist (blue), cancelled (grey).

Rounded corners

8 • 12 • 16 • 24 px, plus fully-round for avatars and pills. Inputs and chips use small rounding, cards use medium/large, bottom sheets round the top corners. Rounded = warm.

Shadows (depth)

Keep shadows soft and subtle. Four levels only: flat backgrounds, cards, the bottom nav / top bars, and pop-ups / sheets. No decorative shadows. In dark mode, lighten the surface instead of adding a shadow.

The parts to build

Build each of these with all its states (normal, hover, pressed, focus, disabled, loading), plus notes on how a screen reader reads it:

- **Buttons** — primary (filled green), secondary (soft fill), text-only, and a “destructive” one for the Console. Only **one** primary button per screen.
- **Inputs** — text field, one-time-code field, picker (use a bottom sheet on phone, not a dropdown), search, toggle, checkbox, radio, date picker. Errors show right under the field.
- **Cards** — content card, the Today devotional card, the verse-of-the-day card (also the share image), event card, streak/progress card. The whole card is tappable.
- **Navigation** — bottom nav bar (5 tabs), side rail (tablet), top bar, Console sidebar, back button.
- **Lists** — a standard row, rows with extra info or a trailing action, section headings, swipe-to-act, and a data table for the Console.
- **Badges and chips** — role tags (Teen, Teacher...), filter chips, and the notification count (the only number badge in the teen app).
- **Tabs** — top tabs for sections inside a screen (max 4). Never tabs inside tabs.
- **Pop-ups** — the teen app prefers **bottom sheets** (slide up from the bottom) over centre pop-ups, except for “are you sure?” confirmations.
- **Bottom sheets** — the workhorse of the app: verse actions, pickers, text-size settings, share, and more. Rounded top, a small grab handle, drag down to close.
- **Charts** (Console and progress) — line, bar, donut, and a calendar heat-map. Always label the axes, use colour-blind-safe colours, no 3D, and design the “no data yet” state.
- **Skeletons** — the soft grey loading placeholders.
- **Media** — video player, podcast player with a small docked mini-player, image with a soft blur-in.

- **Messages** — toast (small message at the bottom), offline bar, and the empty-state block (a small drawing + one line + one button).
- **QR parts** — the ticket QR (works offline, brighten-screen hint) and the Console check-in scanner.

How the parts fit together

Small parts build bigger parts: tokens → basic parts (button, icon, input) → groups (cards, rows) → whole sections (bottom nav, the Bible reader) → full screens.

Rule: a screen should never restyle a part on its own. If something needs to look different, add a proper new version to the kit — don't hack it on one screen.

Icons

- One icon family. Rounded, simple, drawn on a 24px grid (20px in the dense Console).
- Filled versions for the active tab.
- Always pair icons with a text label in navigation.